

IIT English Language Course

”in common with” vs ”common to”

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”in common with” vs ”common to”

”In common with” describes a shared characteristic between two or more entities.

- **Grammar:** ”In common” functions adverbially, often with ”have,” to indicate a shared quality. ”With” introduces the other entity sharing that quality.
- **Focus:** Comparison and shared possession.
- **Example:** ”He has many interests **in common with** his father.” (They both possess those interests.)

”Common to someone/something” describes a characteristic that is widespread among or applies generally to a group or category.

- **Grammar:** ”Common” is an adjective modifying a noun (e.g., ”a belief common...”). ”To” indicates the group or domain where the characteristic is prevalent.
- **Focus:** Prevalence, typicality, or general applicability within a specified group.
- **Example:** ”This behavior is **common to** all adolescents.” (It’s a typical behavior observed across the group of adolescents.)